

Journaler — a quick start

Your writing home for the term · TCE 284 · everything stays on your computer

Journaler is where you do your writing this term. It runs in your browser, and nothing you write is uploaded — it lives on **your** computer. There are four tabs across the top: **Notebook**, **Readings**, **Freewrite**, and **Currere**. It opens on your Notebook, because that is what everything else here feeds.

The four tabs

Freewrite

The five One-Pagers live here, and so do the pages for your **required notebook entries** — see below. Each One-Pager runs in two steps:

1. **Gush** — set the timer and write. While it runs, Backspace and Delete are off. You cannot fix anything, so keep going. Stalled? Write that you stalled.
2. **Shape** — when the buzzer sounds, a composer opens beside your gush. Build your one page from the raw material. Export it as a PDF to hand in.

Currere

The four moments — Regressive, Progressive, Analytical, Synthetical. Same gush-then-shape rhythm, with the structure loosening as you go. Every one of them can be kept in your notebook, including the Analytical comparison.

Readings

Load a chapter with **+ Load readings** (pick several at once) or **+ Load a folder**. Switch chapters from the dropdown. Read one page at a time, or flip to Continuous.

Notebook you start here

Your kept pages, seen four ways: **By day** (a calendar), **By piece** (one piece across the whole term, so you can watch it change), **Turn in** (what you are handing in, and where you stand), and **Threads** (what keeps coming back).

Keeping a page

Your drafts save themselves as you type. When a page is worth keeping, press **+ Add to notebook**. That dates it and files it in your Notebook.

Come back to it. Open the same piece weeks later, write more, and add to notebook again. Both passes stay, dated, so your thinking shows over time.

The four required entries

Four entries are required, and each has its own page under **Freewrite → For the notebook: Why do we write?** (Week 1), **Topic map**, **Source notes**, and your **Look-Back Letter** (Week 15). Write on the page, press **+ Keep in notebook**, and it is filed *and* marked as that required entry in one step — there is nothing to go back and label in December.

The Letter writes back. Open the Look-Back Letter and your Week 1 answer is sitting beside it, so you can see what you said in August while you answer it in December.

Nothing gets lost. Your Notebook lists anything you have written that is not an entry yet — **Not in your notebook yet**, with a **Keep →** beside each. Writing is only counted once you keep it, so clear that list as you

go.

Turning it in

You do not hand in the whole notebook. You hand in a **report** — the pages you chose, and what you made of them. Everything else is counted, not read.

- Open **Notebook → Turn in**. The panel at the top shows the four scored rows and where you stand on each.
- Before you submit, **flag three entries** you want read closely — one from each act of the course.
- Write your reading of one **thread** — something that kept coming back across several entries.
- Press **Bundle notebook → PDF**. That is what you turn in.

Most of it counts without being read. A flagged or required entry is printed in full. Everything else appears as one line in the Contents — numbered, dated, with its word count. That is what keeps the report short and the rest of your notebook genuinely unjudged.

Saving & moving your work

- ⬇ **Save my work** (top bar) downloads one file with everything you have written.
- Put that file wherever you keep things — Google Drive, Dropbox, or a thumb drive.
- On any computer, open Journaler and use ⬆ **Open my file** to pick up where you left off.

Do this often. Your work is saved in this browser, but a lab computer can be wiped. The saved file is your real backup.

The AI partner (optional)

Connect a model with the **AI** button, top right. After a gush, a reflection partner asks how the writing *felt* — it never touches your words. Journaler works fully without AI, too.